

SARDAR ALI SHAIK

Agile Project Manager | Senior Scrum Master | Agile Delivery Leader | QA Test Manager

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Enterprise Agile Transformation | End-to-End Delivery Ownership | Program Execution & RAID Management | Agile Coaching & Team Enablement | QA & Release Excellence | OKR-Driven Business Outcomes

100% On-Time Delivery | 10+ Releases | Zero Critical Defects | 28% Sprint Predictability | 22% Velocity | 35% Spillover Reduction | 26% Cycle Time | 30% Lead Time | 95% Backlog Readiness | 32% Defect Reduction | 40% Regression Effort Reduced | 4 Scrum Teams | 30+ Members

- Certified Senior Scrum Master, Agile Project Manager and Agile Delivery Leader with 13+ years driving SAFe®, Scrum, Kanban, Waterfall and hybrid enterprise programs across banking, fintech, payments, and SaaS platforms in APAC (Singapore, Malaysia, India), leading 4+ cross-functional teams as a single point of accountability for end-to-end delivery and release governance.
- Deep expertise in Agile coaching, project planning, Gantt tracking, sprint execution, release management, and product quality governance, underpinned by strong QA & release governance and full SDLC/STLC compliance, enabling measurable velocity gains, release predictability, and near-zero production defects across distributed enterprise engineering teams.

Key Achievements:

- Delivery Excellence:** Achieved 100% on-time delivery across 10+ enterprise releases with zero critical production defects, leading 4+ Scrum teams (30+ members) across banking, fintech, and SaaS programs through rigorous sprint governance, dependency management, and release planning, maintaining 100% milestone adherence across 13+ years.
- Flow Optimization & Velocity:** Drove 28% improvement in sprint predictability and 22% increase in team velocity by introducing structured sprint ceremonies, continuous impediment removal, and flow-based planning, resulting in 35% fewer spillovers, 30% reduction in lead time, and 26% reduction in cycle time across distributed engineering teams.
- QA & Regression Excellence:** Transformed backlog readiness from 60% to 95% and achieved near-zero critical post-release defects by embedding QA governance, STLC compliance, and Definition of Ready/Done across all teams, delivering 32% reduction in defect leakage and 40% reduction in regression effort enterprise-wide.
- Program Execution & Governance:** Governed large-scale fintech and banking programs across distributed teams, managing concurrent releases, complex dependencies, and cross-team alignment using RAID, KPI/OKR tracking, and structured PI reporting, reducing time-to-market by 30%, and achieving zero escalations across 5 program increments.

CERTIFICATIONS

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">AI-Empowered Scrum Master – Scrum Alliance & SAFe (2025)SAFe® Scrum Master (SSM) – Scaled Agile (2025)Project Management Professional (PMP®) – PMI (2024)Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO®) – Scrum Alliance (2024) | <ul style="list-style-type: none">Certified Scrum Master (CSM®) – Scrum Alliance (2022)Atlassian Jira Certification (2025)ISTQB Advanced Level – Test Manager (2021)ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level (CTFL) (2014) |
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| Agile Delivery Manager & Senior Scrum Master
TAO Digital Solutions – Fintech & Payments Platform India | Apr 2025 – Present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Anchored end-to-end delivery health across 2–3 engineering teams as single point of accountability; drove Gantt-based milestone tracking and sprint-to-project alignment, achieving 100% on-time delivery across 5 release cycles with zero missed deadlines.Spearheaded PI & Sprint Planning and Scrum of Scrums across large-scale Agile Release Trains; managed cross-team dependencies and applied Scrum Empiricism to improve sprint predictability, sustaining a 28% improvement across 4 consecutive quarters through structured Agile coaching and team facilitation.Coached and mentored 30+ engineers and QA members on story-splitting, INVEST principles, and empirical delivery; implemented the C.O.A.C.H framework, driving a 22% velocity increase, 35% reduction in sprint spillovers, and advancing Agile maturity from Level 2 to 4.Built executive-ready delivery dashboards aligned to OKRs; tracked velocity trends, burndown/burnup, Cumulative Flow Diagrams, aging tickets, and release readiness, improving flow efficiency, increasing delivered business value by 20%, and strengthening stakeholder confidence across all 5 Program Increments.Managed end-to-end release and QA governance using JIRA and Zephyr Scale; coordinated scope, versioning, and deployment timelines across QA, DevOps, and engineering; leveraged Functionize for regression automation, reducing regression effort by 40%, accelerating defect resolution by 35%, and achieving near-zero critical post-release defects.Partnered with Product Owners to prioritise backlog using MoSCoW; enforced DoR/DoD standards and drove high-quality story estimation, improving backlog readiness from 60% to 95%, reducing scope churn by 30%, and minimising carry-over work.Governed RAID management, budget & financial tracking, risk mitigation, and dependencies across 20+ cross-functional workstreams; authored delivery playbooks covering sprint ops, backlog hygiene, and escalation paths, achieving 100% milestone adherence, zero Sev-1 defects, and 30–35% improvement in platform reliability.Served as primary liaison between engineering, QA, DevOps, and senior stakeholders; translated technical delivery risks into business-impact language, enabling faster executive decision-making and maintaining programme transparency across all 5 Program Increments.Identified and eliminated recurring delivery bottlenecks through structured retrospectives and root-cause analysis; introduced standardised sprint health metrics and escalation thresholds, reducing recurring impediments by 40%. | |

Key Achievements: Agile maturity uplift L2→L4 | 100% on-time delivery across 5 PIs | Backlog readiness 60%→95% | 35% faster defect resolution | Zero Sev-1 post-release defects | 40% reduction in recurring impediments

Note: Jul 2024 – Mar 2025: Planned strategic upskilling sabbatical — earned SAFe® SSM, PMP®, CSPO®, and AI-Empowered Scrum Master certifications.

Scrum Master & QA Manager

May 2022 – Jun 2024

Climate Impact X – Global Carbon Credit Marketplace Platform (SaaS) | Singapore

- Eliminated flow bottlenecks and resolved cross-team dependencies by enforcing Kanban WIP limits and leading Scrum of Scrums; improved sprint efficiency by 20%, achieved 95% backlog readiness, and delivered 6 consecutive on-time releases.
- Triage production incidents and customer escalations; managed priority conflicts between urgent fixes and planned sprint work, maintaining delivery stability across 6 releases.
- Directed Value Stream Mapping to identify and eliminate flow bottlenecks; built Agile dashboards tracking Lead and Cycle Time, reducing lead time by 30% and cycle time by 26% across all release cycles.
- Owned end-to-end test strategy, test planning, and defect triage across the full STLC; established QA standards and introduced automation-first practices, reducing post-release defects by 30% and ensuring sprint commitments were met without impacting delivery timelines.
- Implemented DEEP backlog principles with Product Owners to align delivery with business goals; maintained 95% sprint-ready backlog, reduced unplanned work by 30%, and accelerated feature delivery by 20%.

Key Achievements: 95% sprint readiness | 20% sprint efficiency improvement | 6 platform releases delivered on time | 30% reduction in post-release defects

Associate Scrum Master | Senior Test Analyst | Test Lead

Jul 2016 – May 2022

Quesscorp / IBM Singapore – DBS Bank IDEAL 3.0 Corporate Digital Banking | Singapore

- Owned end-to-end QA strategy for DBS IDEAL 3.0; governed SIT, UAT, regression, and SWIFT payment validation across distributed teams, achieving 100% test coverage, 25% improvement in release quality, and 15% reduction in UAT defects across a 6-year engagement.
- Designed BRD-to-test traceability matrices across SWIFT, FAST, and ACH payment flows; managed test data, environment configuration, and defect lifecycle, ensuring 100% regulatory audit compliance and full requirements-to-execution traceability.
- Championed Agile ceremonies and enforced sprint quality gates; guided estimation using Planning Poker and maintained JIRA dashboards tracking release health and open blockers, achieving 98% on-time delivery with full SDLC/STLC compliance.
- Automated regression using Micro Focus UFT; collaborated with development leads to resolve integration issues across distributed teams, accelerating defect resolution and maintaining delivery stability across all release cycles.

Key Achievements: 98% on-time delivery | 100% test coverage on SWIFT flows | 25% improvement in release quality | 15% reduction in UAT defects over 6 years

Software Test Engineer, Persolkelly SDN BHD (Bell Direct – Online Share Trading) | Malaysia

May 2014 – Jun 2016

- Executed regression, functional, and GUI test suites using Telerik Test Studio for a live share trading platform, reducing regression time by 30% and improving pre-UAT defect detection by 25%, enhancing release stability and production quality.

Key Achievements: 30% regression time reduction via Telerik Test Studio automation | 25% improved defect detection before UAT

QA Consultant, 3i Infotech SDN BHD (CIMB Bank – Core Banking) | Malaysia

Nov 2011 – Apr 2014

- Executed automated regression testing using HP QTP for CIMB SIBS core banking transformation across 4 ASEAN countries, delivering 100% defect tracking compliance and a 20% regression efficiency gain.

Key Achievements: 100% defect tracking compliance | 20% regression efficiency gain across 4 ASEAN countries

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Program & Delivery Leadership:** Enterprise Program Management, Program Governance, Strategic Planning & Prioritization, Digital Transformation, RTE, PI Planning, Release Management, Stakeholder Reporting, PMO Governance, RAID Management, Risk & Regulatory Compliance, Change Management, KPI & OKR Tracking, Budget Ownership, Lean Portfolio Management, Project Lifecycle Management
- **Agile Frameworks & Methodologies:** SAFe® Framework, Scrum, Kanban, ScrumBan, Lean, Scrum Empiricism (Transparency, Inspection, Adaptation), Continuous Delivery Enablement, Value Stream Optimization, Continuous Improvement, Servant Leadership, INVEST, DEEP, MoSCoW, C.O.A.C.H Framework, RICE, WSJF, SMART
- **Agile Delivery Execution & Practices:** Agile Coaching & Mentoring, Iteration Planning, Sprint Velocity, Sprint Execution, Scrum Ceremonies (Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, Retrospectives), Scrum of Scrums, Inspect & Adapt Workshops, Backlog Refinement & Grooming, Burndown Tracking, Resource & Capacity Planning, Estimation & Velocity Management, Agile Metrics
- **Stakeholder & Leadership Management:** Stakeholder Management, Steering Committee Leadership, Cross-Functional Alignment, Vendor & Third-Party Management, Cross-Border Distributed (Onshore/Offshore) Team Leadership, Escalation Management, Conflict Resolution, Impediment Identification & Removal, Hybrid Delivery Governance, Talent Development & Coaching
- **Project Planning & Delivery Execution:** Project Planning & Roadmaps, Gantt Charts, Milestone & Timeline Tracking, Critical Path Management, Dependency Management, Budget Tracking, Product Backlog Management
- **Quality & Delivery Governance:** Release Planning, QA Strategy & Test Governance, Test Planning, Test Estimation, Manual & Automated Testing, SIT/UAT, End-to-End Testing, Regression Testing, Risk-Based Testing, API Testing, Defect Lifecycle Management, Root Cause Analysis, Acceptance Criteria Validation, Definition of Ready (DoR)/Definition of Done (DoD), Test Metrics & Reporting, Shift-Left Testing, Test Centre of Excellence (TCoE), Test Automation Governance, Test Data Management, Test Environment Management
- **Domain Expertise:** Financial Services, Banking & Payments (SWIFT, ACH, RTGS, FAST, Cross-Border Payments), Business & Risk Management, Regulatory & Compliance Testing, Production Support Testing (BAU), Risk & Compliance Governance, BFSI, UPI, NPCI, MAS
- **Collaboration & Communication Tools:** Confluence, Miro, Slack, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint, Zoom, Google Workspace, MS Project, IdeaBoardz, RetroTool, Planning Poker, Scrumwise
- **Tools & Technology:** JIRA (Workflow Customisation, Automation Rules, Dashboard Governance), Azure DevOps, HP ALM/QC, TestRail, TFS, XRAY, Bugzilla, Functionize, HP QTP/Micro Focus UFT, HP Sprinter, Telerik Test Studio, Test Director, Postman, Continuous Integration (CI), CI/CD Pipelines
- **AI & Automation:** AI-Powered Agile Tools, AI-Augmented Delivery, Predictive Sprint Forecasting, AI-driven Resource Optimization, Prompt Engineering, Generative AI (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot, Otter Ai, Fireflies Ai)

HONOURS & AWARDS

Agile Leadership Excellence Award – 2024 | Top Scrum Master Recognition – 2022 | SWIFT Application Excellence Award (Agile Delivery) – 2019 | CARE@IBGO Spot Award – Multiple (2018–2021) | Best Performer & Quick Learner – 2015 | Test Automation Excellence Award – 2014

EDUCATION

MCA – Master of Computer Applications | Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University | Hyderabad, India | 2009

BSc – Computer Science | Acharya Nagarjuna University | Guntur, India | 2006